

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Hugh Bidder

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison

Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

- Buys art for **Elon Mosaic**. **Elon** likes to pretend he found it himself. Hugh doesn't mind.
- **Penny Pincher** asks Hugh for auction previews, then argues with every estimate. He hates dealing with her.
- Keeps offering to represent **Vincent Van Faux**. **Vincent** wants to discuss the commission before the paintings.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, suave, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself. You're the coolest guy in the room and you know it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Hugh Bidder. Everything has a price. My charming conversation is the only exception, and even that is negotiable.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Hugh Bidder

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Your other secret

You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Conversations to start

- Learn whether Saul D. Bid knows about the disputed certificate.
- Keep Elon Mosaic from discussing the 'auction incident' in public.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *A seat with a cold metallic skeleton keeps its secret underneath.*
- 2 *A little door hides shelves and, tonight, a secret.*
- 3 *A book beginning with creation has a secret between its pages.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The certificate was forged before it reached me. Grant proposed an elegant correction: I refund millions and let everyone believe I made it. I altered my file after the sale because I looked like a fool. That alteration was mine. The forgery was someone else's. Grant enjoyed blurring the distinction.

IF MURDERER

Grant wanted millions back for a certificate forged before I saw it. He also wanted the pleasure of calling me a forger in public. Yes, I altered the sale file afterward. Clients pay for confidence; I supplied some I had not earned. Grant discovered a very expensive way to make me listen.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I argued with him in the salon before the glass arrived. From 6:39 until 6:45 I used the fixed auction-booth handset to renegotiate the sale. 'Violet reserve' was the buyer's absurd password. I had to admit the altered file. A six-minute confession to a client is quite enough for one evening.

IF MURDERER

I argued with Grant before the glass arrived, then took the buyer's call on my mobile in the gallery. I moved to the side passage for a quieter connection and came back before the toast. A threatened lawsuit is best conducted without an auctioneer supplying commentary over your shoulder.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed the chronology in the certificate file after the sale. The buyer's refund instructions are folded behind it. Grant could make that alteration sound like the original forgery if he left out the dates, which he intended to do. My client was about to learn what my confidence had cost them.

IF MURDERER

The amended certificate file was in my jacket beside the buyer's refund instructions. I changed its chronology after discovering the forgery. Grant had a copy of the earlier version and wanted a valuation left in his salon. He could never decide whether my paperwork was worthless or urgently required.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACCUSATIONS



Hugh Bidder

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Hugh Bidder

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed an alteration to my sale file. The recorded bid-booth conversation, including the ridiculous password, kept me away from the exposed coupe. I have lost a client and probably a substantial fee. I did not poison Grant. If anyone still wishes to acquire the bowl, we should begin with its actual ownership.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The client was waiting while I made a different adjustment. I went to the salon, took the stolen toxin onto a museum cloth and coated the empty coupe. My mobile call could follow me anywhere; the recorded bid-booth conversation was not mine. Grant intended to sell my reputation back to me. I killed him before he could collect.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
